

Physics

(A Level, OCR A)

Our A Level Physics A specification takes a content led approach to the course. This is a flexible approach where the specification is divided into topics, each covering different key concepts of physics. As learners progress through the course, they'll build on their knowledge of the laws of physics, applying their understanding to areas from sub-atomic particles to the entire universe.

We're striving for good science that's straightforward and engaging to teach, with fair, challenging and relevant assessment that works well in centres and promotes practical activity.

In order to be successful you are expected to practise the work we do outside of lessons and to read around the subject to deepen understanding.

Teaching modules: Year 12: Development of practical skills in physics, foundations of physics, forces and motion, electrons, waves and photons. Year 13: Newtonian world and astrophysics, particles and medical physics.

Entry Requirements:

In Combined (Double) Science: Grade 6 in both exams.

In Separate (Triple) Science: Grade 6 in the Physics exams, plus another 6 in another Science GCSE.

In addition to the science results, we require a minimum of a grade 6 in Mathematics.

Course content

Units	%	When?	Content
Modelling physics (Component 01)	37%	May/June at end of Year 13	This component is worth 100 marks and is split into two sections and assesses content from teaching modules 1, 2, 3 and 5. Learners answer all questions. Section A contains multiple choice questions. This section of the paper is worth 15 marks. Section B includes short answer question styles (structured questions, problem solving, calculations, practical) and extended response questions. This section of the paper is worth 85 marks.
Exploring physics (Component 02)	37%	May/June at end of Year 13	This component is worth 100 marks and is split into two sections and assesses content from teaching modules 1, 2, 4 and 6. Learners answer all questions. Section A contains multiple choice questions. This section of the paper is worth 15 marks. Section B includes short answer question styles (structured questions, problem solving, calculations, practical) and extended response questions. This section of the paper is worth 85 marks.
Unified physics (Component 03)	26%	May/June at end of Year 13	This component assesses content from across all teaching modules 1 to 6. Learners answer all questions. This component is worth 70 marks. Question styles include short answer (structured questions, problem solving, calculations, practical) and extended response questions.
Practical Endorsement	Pass or Fail	May at end of Year 13	Course endorsed practical skills are assessed continuously by the teacher(s) and only at the completion of the course is a pass or fail assessment submitted to the exam board.

Costs associated with this course

We recommend students purchase this revision and practice guide:

CGP A-Level Physics: OCR A Year 1 and 2 Complete Revision and Practice [ISBN-10 : 1789080398]

Cost new is typically £16.

Optional - To help bridge the gap between A-Level and GCSE physics we recommend the following: CGP Head Start to A-Level Physics [ISBN-10 : 1782942815]. Cost new is typically £5.

You do not need any textbooks to complete the course. We give you access to an online version of the recommended textbook via Kerboodle, and we have copies for students in lessons and in the library. Details of the textbook below: A Level Physics for OCR A Student Book (OCR A Level Sciences) Paperback – 2 July 2015 [ISBN-10 : 0198352182]. Cost new is typically £43.

Career Links

A Level Physics is widely respected and highly valued by employers and institutions alike. Students who have studied Physics have gone on to do apprenticeships or study varying types of Engineering, Physics, Computer Science, Law, Product Design, Naval Architecture, Radiography, Audio Technology, Finance and much, much more.

For more information please contact Dr Evans (Sc7)